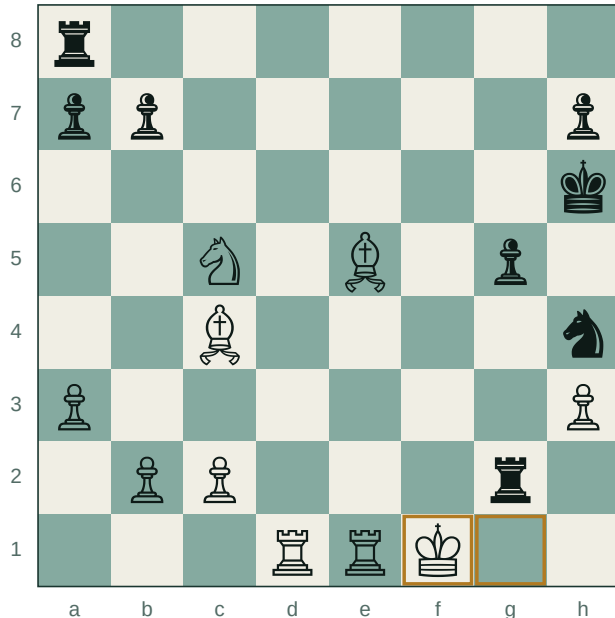


Mate in three: Black, move 32

Mate in three

Black to move



Previous move: 32.Kf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

32...Rf8+ 33. Bf7 Rxf7+ 34. Bf4 Rxf4#

32...Rf8+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33.Bf7**.

33...Rxf7+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on f7. Recorded reply: **34.Bf4**.

34...Rxf4# Mate: rook on f4 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on f1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on f4. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not stop at a promising check. The final mating position must still be legal after every intervening move.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Longer mating lines require accurate visualization. Track the king's square, opened lines, and every sacrificed piece through the entire sequence.

HOW TO LOOK

Work backward from a mating pattern, then calculate forward with the opponent choosing the strongest defense.

The defending king is on f1. Geometrically undefended: knight on c5 and bishop on c4. Check for tactical protection.